

Lab: Feel the Beat

Goal

To feel your body system working and see how it changes when you act.

What You Need

- Your body!
- A stopwatch or clock (optional)

Steps

1. The Resting Beat

Sit very still on the floor. Be quiet as a mouse. Put two fingers gently on the side of your neck (under the jaw) or on your wrist. Wait until you feel a thump-thump. That is your heart pumping blood! **Count:** How many beats in 10 seconds? [Write it down]

2. The Active Beat

Stand up. Do 20 Jumping Jacks as fast as you can! Go! Stop and find your pulse again immediately. **Count:** How many beats in 10 seconds now? [Write it down]

3. Compare

Was the second number bigger? Your muscles needed more energy, so your heart pumped faster!

My Body Log

State	Heartbeats (in 10 sec)	How did I feel?
Resting		(Calm? Sleepy?)
Active		(Out of breath? Hot?)

What We Learned

Your body is smart. It changes what it does (pumping faster) to help you do what you want (jump).